

Weekly Writing - Week 1

Conor Heikkila

29 August, 2025

1. What is more valuable, coding by hand or a good understanding of the concepts and methods of data analysis?

Between spending time learning every detail of coding and focusing more on the ideas behind data analysis, I think the concepts matter more. If I mess up the code, I can always Google the error, ask for help, or use AI to figure it out. But if I don't understand what the numbers mean or I pick the wrong method, the analysis won't be useful no matter how perfect the code is. To me, the important part is knowing when something is correlation vs causation, or what assumptions I'm making when I run a test. That's what actually helps me learn how to tell a story with data. Coding is still important, but the big picture skills feel like the ones that will stick with me and be useful in different situations later on.